

COURSE OUTLINE

Principles of Business Administration

The full course at a glance — eight lessons, from what a business is to how it manages change.

BBA 1110 · University of Zambia

8 lessons · 9 steps · Bookless · bookless.framer.ai

OVERVIEW

About This Course

BBA 1110 is the foundation course of the Business Administration programme. It builds the vocabulary and the mental model you carry into every later course: what a business is, the environment it operates in, and how managers plan, organise, direct, and control the work to reach an objective.

The course runs as eight lessons, and each lesson is its own Slack channel. A lesson is one frame of the subject; it holds the step — or steps — that cover that frame. Lessons are kept to a single step wherever the material allows; only Foundations runs to two, because its two topics are genuinely distinct. Every step is a Bookless PDF you can read in a sitting, built around Zambian companies and ZMW figures so the examples match the market you know.

Each lesson is its own channel for a reason: it keeps conversations split by topic. Someone working through Finance is never pulled into a Marketing thread, and the other way round — you study and discuss in the room for the frame you are in.

THE LESSONS

The Course, Lesson by Lesson

#	Step	What it covers
LESSON 1 · FOUNDATIONS #bba-foundations		
1.1	Introduction to Business Administration	What a business is, the three sectors of the economy, the five types of business organisation, business objectives, and the stakeholders who have a claim on the firm.
1.2	Design & Structure of Organisations	How a firm arranges people and authority: hierarchy, span of control, chain of command, centralisation versus delegation, and the common organisational structures.
LESSON 2 · THE BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT #bba-environment		
2.1	The Impact of the Environment	The external forces that shape every business decision — political, economic, social, technological, legal, and environmental (PESTLE) — and how firms respond to them.
LESSON 3 · MANAGEMENT FUNCTIONS #bba-management		
3.1	Management Functions & Processes	The core work of a manager in one place: planning and organising, then leading and controlling — with leadership styles, motivation, delegation, and decision-making.

#	Step	What it covers
LESSON 4 · PRODUCTION & OPERATIONS #bba-production		
4.1	Production	How goods and services are made: production methods (job, batch, flow), operations management, quality, and productivity.
LESSON 5 · MARKETING #bba-marketing		
5.1	Marketing	Identifying and satisfying customer needs: market research, segmentation, and the marketing mix — product, price, place, and promotion.
LESSON 6 · FINANCE #bba-finance		
6.1	Finance	Where money comes from and how it is managed: sources of finance, cost behaviour, budgeting, and reading the basic financial statements.
LESSON 7 · HUMAN RESOURCES #bba-human-resources		
7.1	Human Resources	Managing people: workforce planning, recruitment and selection, training and development, motivation, and the employment relationship.
LESSON 8 · CHANGE MANAGEMENT #bba-change		
8.1	Change & the Management of Change	Why organisations must change, where resistance comes from, and how managers lead change so it sticks.

OUTCOMES

What You Should Be Able to Do

- Explain what a business is, the sectors it operates in, and the legal forms it can take.
- Describe how organisations are structured and why structure affects performance.
- Apply the four management functions — plan, organise, direct, control — to a real case.
- Outline how production, marketing, finance, and human resources work and connect.
- Analyse the external environment and stakeholder interests around a Zambian business.
- Explain how and why organisations manage change, and why people resist it.

Each lesson lands in its Slack channel as it is released. Start with Lesson 1.1 in #bba-foundations and work through in order — the course is built to be read that way.